



SIGNAL

SPRING 2026 ISSUE



Vern Eide
EMPLOYEE OWNED

Our Vision: To enhance the lives of our employees, customers, and the community
Our Mission: We Deliver Dreams

THE SIGNAL'S SPRING FEATURED VEHICLE:

Tom Borchard's

KAWASAKI NINJA

The Story Behind the Ride

Some builds start with a plan. Others start with a feeling.

For Tom Borchard (Marketing/Web Director)

this one started with a little bit of both.

Tom first learned how to ride on a 1997 Kawasaki Ninja, a bike he owned and rode for years before eventually selling it. But in 2017, after coming across a great deal on a 2004 Ninja 250, those memories came rushing back, and he pulled the trigger, adding a Ninja back into his garage.

When Tom bought the bike, it was stock, wrapped in plastic and untouched. Inspiration came when his brother sent him a photo of another Ninja transformed into a café racer. That image sparked the idea, and from there, Tom committed to building something entirely his own.

What followed was no small project. The transformation required cutting the frame, which he cites as the most stressful part of the build, along with completely reworking the bike's lighting and wiring. New headlights, taillights, and signals all had to be installed. One of Tom's favorite upgrades is the custom gauge cluster and housing, which he installed himself. After months of work, Tom completed the build on the morning of Christmas Eve in 2018.



Green and Obnoxious

With the mechanical work complete, the final step was giving the bike a fresh coat of paint. Tom dropped the bike off at the Vern Eide Body Shop before heading out on vacation, leaving the paint team with just two words of direction: “Green and Obnoxious.”

The result is impossible to ignore: a bright and original finish that matches the spirit of the build.

Built to Be Seen

This isn't a bike that blends in, and Tom wouldn't have it any other way. When he brings it to shows, the Ninja regularly brings home awards: including People's Choice Baddest Motorcycle at the 2022 Motoplex Bike Show. But for Tom, the recognition is only an added bonus.

More than anything, this build represents the boldest project he's ever taken on. From cutting into the frame to reimagining nearly every component, it pushed him to take risks, and proved that those risks could pay off in the end.

It's also a bike that invites conversation. Whether it's the color, the style, or the transformation itself, people are naturally drawn to it, and Tom enjoys every bit of that attention. In the end, this Ninja serves as a reflection of creativity, and the willingness to build something different. A great example that it's the story behind the vehicle that defines them.



*Let us
know
about your
ride for a
possible
future issue
of the
Signal!*



Welcome to the Vern Eide Family

Congrats to Annika Marquez and her husband, who just welcomed baby Sofia to their family.

Annika works as an Accounting Title Clerk at Vern Eide Arrowhead Parkway. Even though Annika loves spending time with the new addition, she says she'll be back to work at the end of May.



Annika Marquez and Sofia

Cheers to Vern Eide Honda Service Advisor Emily Swanger (right) on her recent marriage to Michelle Wellnitz.

The couple tied the knot on March 5 in Punta Cana, Dominican Republic. Congratulations as you embark on your new adventure!



Emily Swanger (right) and Michelle Wellnitz

Thanks for the Memories

Bill Koons

After 38 years at Vern Eide, Bill Koons is taking retirement for a spin.

Thanks for all you've done over the decades, and enjoy the road ahead.



John Wassom

After 8 years of service with Vern Eide, John Wassom is retiring!

Thank you for your service, John - you will be missed!



Mother's Day: May 10th

Don't forget - Mother's Day is May 10. Whether you celebrate with a card, a meal, a thoughtful gift, or spending quality time together, Mother's Day is a chance to say "thank you" for the everyday moments and the lifelong support moms give.

Take the day to make your mom or other important female in your life feel appreciated, cherished, and loved.

Tell Us About You!

We want to hear from you!

If you have news you want to share with your fellow Vern Eide co-workers, we want to hear from you!

Send engagement and wedding photos, birth announcements and more to:

vvnewsletterevents@gmail.com

First Car Flashback

We're collecting photos for a new segment, "**First Car Flashback.**" Show us your Novas, Chevettes and everything in between- the first car you got to call your very own. You can send pictures to:

vvnewsletterevents@gmail.com

Put: "First Car" in the subject line.



Image used for reference:
We DO NOT condone hippo drawn carriages

Want your car on the cover of The Signal?

Just scan this code and fill out the form!

What's in it for you:

- Professional **Photo Shoot** of **your** vehicle!
- A framed copy of **your car** on the cover!
- A chance to share **your ride's story!**
- Bragging rights.



The Legend is Back



The 2026 Honda Prelude on the streets of Sioux Falls.

Guess what's back at Vern Eide Honda? The Honda Prelude - and it's making a comeback after more than 20 years.

The Prelude first arrived in the U.S. in 1979 as Honda's sporty, more premium model, and it quickly earned a loyal following. Honda kept the Prelude around until 2001, then it disappeared from showrooms for about 20 years.



Now it's back, but with a modern twist. The 2026 Prelude is a hybrid-electric with two-motor technology. That means quicker acceleration, smooth and responsive driving, and the ability to run on electric power alone at low speeds. There's no traditional manual gearbox or clutch this time, but the car offers simulated gears so you can still enjoy a hands-on driving feel.

Want to see one in person? Vern Eide Honda currently has two on

the lot but they're likely to sell fast — so don't wait too long to check it out.

April Hygiene Drive

Hygiene Supply Drive

For Solace: Sioux Falls' first integrated healing agency, uniting crisis care, clinical care, and healing arts.

April 1-30

Collection bins will be at all Vern Eide Sioux Falls locations, Coffea and First Bank & Trust

Personal Care (full-size preferred):

- Shampoo & conditioner (*men & women*)
- Body wash & deodorant (*men & women*)
- Toothbrushes (*individually packaged*) & toothpaste
- Tampons
- Razors

Household Essentials:

- NEW bed-in-a-bag sets (*twin, queen, king*)
- NEW sheet sets (*twin, queen, king*)
- All-purpose cleaner
- Laundry soap (*prefer 28 fl oz size*)

Other Ways to Give:

- Fuel-only gas gift cards: (*can mail to or drop off at: 2210 S Brown Place, Sioux Falls, SD 57105*)
- Amazon Wish List: Amazon.com



April Hygiene Drive

Together, we can make a difference



solace

Questions? hello@seeksolace.care
Website: seeksolace.care



IT Tip: How to Change or Update Your Password

Updating your password regularly helps keep your account and company systems secure. Here's the quickest way to change it on a Windows computer:

Step-by-Step Instructions (After Logging in)

1. Press **CTRL + ALT + DEL** (Press all three keys at the same time on your keyboard.) You will see a menu appear on your screen.
2. Select **"Change a password"**
Click the option labeled Change a password.
3. **Enter your password details**
You'll be prompted to fill in: Old password, New password, Confirm password
Make sure your new password meets our company's complexity requirements (**uppercase, lowercase, number, symbol, etc.**)
4. Click **"OK"**

If everything matches and meets policy requirements, your password will update successfully.

IT TIP

HOW TO CHANGE/UPDATE YOUR PASSWORD (CTRL+ALT+DEL METHOD)

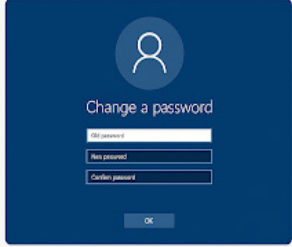
Press Ctrl, Alt, and Del all at once.

Ctrl

Alt

Del

→



Time to Get "Reel"

The ice is off the water in many places across the Midwest, and for many that means one thing: fishing! Soo Sports at Vern Eide Marine is busy selling and leasing new and used boats- this will be the first summer that the two operate as one store.

The call of the walleye has once again proved too strong for Vern Eide Leasing Consultant Joe Bruggeman. Joe retired from Vern Eide, got bored. came back and is now working part time. As you can see in this photo, when he's not in the office Joe is on the water reeling in as many fish as he can.



Keep It Up!

You set a weight-loss goal for 2026 — good for you. Now, with 2026 a quarter over, the real work is keeping it going. Whether you're down a few pounds or still climbing toward your target, maintaining momentum comes down to good habits, realistic expectations, and steady progress.

- Make food simple and sustainable. You don't need a strict diet. Prioritize whole foods, protein at each meal, vegetables, and controlled portions. Plan meals, keep healthy snacks available, and allow an occasional treat — deprivation backfires.
- Build a support system. Share goals with a friend, join a class, or use an online community. Accountability partners boost consistency and make the journey less lonely.
- Plan for setbacks — and move on. Plateaus, travel, holidays — they happen. Expect them, plan for them, and don't let one week define the year. Return to your plan immediately after a setback.
- Celebrate non-scale victories. Weight is just one measure. Celebrate better sleep, more energy, improved strength, looser clothes, or higher confidence.

Vern Eide has tools that can help employees live their best lives 365 days a year.

That includes the Eide Excelerate program, which tracks the number of steps a person takes a quarter; those results can result in a cash reward. Employees can also take advantage of the onsite gym located on the Mitsubishi campus. Full-time employees can receive a free gym membership at participating Great Life facilities. Have questions? Contact Camille or Jodi in HR or scan the QR code.





Our Reason Why: To improve the quality of life for our employees, our customers, and our community.

Because you choose to show up every day and do what you do with excellence, we're able to give to non-profit organizations and missions that exist to serve the greater good of our community.

April Donations

Bethany Lutheran Foundation - Monetary donation to help raise funds to build a fitness center for elderly residents to continue movement of their bodies and prolong life.

SD Huntington's Disease Society - Monetary donation supporting the improvement of lives of those affected by Huntington's Disease with services and education plus advocacy and research.

SD Arthritis Foundation - Monetary donation raising funds and awareness toward youth with arthritis.

Pioneer Memorial Hospital - Monetary donation supporting this rural health care system to raise funds for needed facility improvements for patients in the hospital and residents in the nursing home.

Midwest Best 5k - Monetary donation raising funds for first responders of Sioux Falls experiencing hardship covering therapy services and medical expenses

Camp Bring It On - Monetary donation to offset cost of this specialized camp for kids with cancer. The camp allows children to experience typical summer activities in a medically safe environment.

New Haven Ministries - Monetary donation supporting their mission of providing therapy, drug and alcohol addiction counseling and more through a faith led journey.

EIDE EFFECT HEROES APRIL 2026



Logan Pry
Sales Consultant



"His luscious golden curls can light up the entire Marine show floor any day of the week, and most assuredly do. It's always a pleasure interacting with him when I'm in the area"

Nominated by Alex Cady
UDrive



Cole Kegler
Accelerated Technician



"I choose to nominate Cole Kegler. He works hard and is always willing to help me or anyone out. Any task I've ever given him gets done in a timely manner."

Nominated by Hailey Milne
Vern Eide Acura



Jon Hessel
Service Attendant



"Handling everything with brains, guts, and style. You've tackled every surprise, every curveball, like snakes, snakes trying to get in your way, and you didn't miss a beat."

Nominated by Justin Smith
Vern Eide Honda



Joe Wentland
Detailer



"Joe not only has the expertise and detail oriented skill to prepare cars for customers, but he also has the right attitude for the job. Through my interactions with Joe, I see the Eide Effect values"

Nominated by Josh Reynolds
Vern Eide Mitsubishi



Jeff Carlson
Sales Consultant



"Their willingness to be approachable and available for any of our video needs demonstrates a tremendous "can-do" attitude that serves the greater good of Vern Eide."

Nominated by Jordan Born
VVI



Dustin Hayes
Parts Advisor



"He always has the best life advice and knows exactly what to say to make your day better. He deserves this not only for those reasons but also for the pride and reliability he brings to the Vern Eide community!"

Nominated by Isaac Habinck
Vern Eide Honda

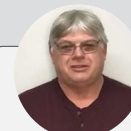


Barb Pierkowski
Customer Care Representative



"Barb exemplifies grace and humility, which are invaluable in a customer care position. She treats external and internal customers alike. t's so often why I seek the wisdom and guidance of Barb."

Nominated by Nettie Lawrence
Vern Eide Motoplex



Darin Schliemann
Detailer



"This well-deserved recognition goes to Darin, who is one of those coworkers you can always count on. He works hard every single day and never seems to slow down."

Nominated by Tyson Viessman
Vern Eide Powerhouse

Vern Eide JUMBLED

The Scrambled Word Downtime Killer!

The letters of these crazy words are all mixed up. Unscramble them to make real words you can find in Clint Eastwood films. Write one letter per square. The circled letters will help you solve the final phrase!

LPAE

HINT: Not Leap

AOCMH

YLUG



Put Answer Here:

“”

SUDOKU

4		1		9		6	7	
7	2		6	3		1		5
6			7		5	4		
5		8	9	4			3	
		2	5		7		4	1
	7	4			3	9	5	
	1	7	3	5	6	2	9	4
2			1		9		6	
	9	6						7



PLAY THE VERDLE
THE DAILY UPDATING WORD GAME
SCAN HERE TO PLAY!

Crossword

Across

3. Clothing brand / collared shirts
4. “Dire _____”
6. Inland body of water
7. Another word for skull
8. Place for hay and horses
9. Civil War general who became U.S. president
11. Montana national park
13. Alice in Chains song / male chicken

Down

1. Inventor of alternating current / Car company
2. Planet / former GM car brand
3. Church lectern used for sermons
5. Director of Pulp Fiction
10. Type of engine fuel
12. Boat brand that makes the Tyee

